V E L A

P R I V A T E C O M M A N D I N F R A S T R U C T U R E

Telegram Setup Guide

How to set up Telegram, create your VELA bot, and create your command group.
Do this before your installation call.

Your judgment. Our infrastructure.

Pre-Installation · Takes about 15 minutes · March 2026

TELEGRAM SETUP GUIDE

Hannah lives in Telegram. It is how you talk to her, how she delivers your morning brief, how she alerts you when something needs your attention, and how she delivers work from your specialist agents. Telegram is not optional — it is the command channel.

By the end of this guide you will have four things ready for the installation call:

What	Looks Like	Where to Store It
Telegram app	Installed on your iPhone	Pinned to your home screen
Bot Token	1234567890:AAEabc_longstring	Password manager
Your Telegram User ID	A positive number, e.g. 8248659673	Password manager
Your Group ID	A negative number, e.g. -1003750313044	Password manager

Do not skip the group setup at the end. The group is where Hannah posts full agent outputs — research briefs, financial models, contract reviews. Without a group, that output has nowhere to go.

1 Install Telegram on Your iPhone

2 minutes

1 Open the App Store on your iPhone

Tap the blue App Store icon on your home screen.

→ **Tap App Store**

2 Search for Telegram

Tap the Search tab at the bottom of the screen. Tap the search bar at the top.

→ **Type: Telegram**

The result you want is called Telegram Messenger. The icon is a white paper plane on a blue background. It is made by Telegram FZ-LLC.

→ **Tap GET → Tap INSTALL (or the cloud download icon if you've had it before)**

3 Open Telegram and create your account

Once installed, tap Open. Telegram asks for your phone number.

→ **Enter your phone number → Tap Next**

Telegram sends a verification code by SMS. Enter the code when it arrives. You may also be asked to set a name — use your real name. This is what Hannah sees.

4	**Allow notifications** Telegram asks if it can send you notifications. This is important — Hannah's alerts and briefs come through Telegram notifications. → **Tap Allow**

2 Get Your Telegram User ID

2 minutes

Your User ID is a number that uniquely identifies your Telegram account. The installer needs it to configure who Hannah will respond to. Here is exactly how to find it.

5	**Open the Telegram search** In Telegram on your iPhone, tap the magnifying glass icon at the top of the screen (or pull down on the chat list to reveal the search bar). → **Tap the Search icon**

6	**Search for userinfobot** Type userinfobot in the search bar. Look for a result with that exact name — it has a small robot icon. → **Type: userinfobot → Tap the result**

7	**Start the bot** You land on the bot's profile page. Tap the START button at the bottom of the screen. → **Tap START**

The bot immediately replies with a message. It looks like this:

Your ID:	`8248659673`

First name:	`John`

Username:	`@yourname`

→ Copy the number next to Your ID — that is your User ID

It is a long positive number. Save it in your password manager labeled: Telegram User ID

3 Create Your VELA Bot

5 minutes

Your bot is Hannah's presence in Telegram. When you message "your bot" you are talking to Hannah. Creating a bot takes about 5 minutes using Telegram's official bot creator, called BotFather.

8	**Search for BotFather** Go back to Telegram search. Type BotFather. → **Type: BotFather → Tap the result**

The correct BotFather has a blue checkmark next to its name — this confirms it is the official Telegram account. Do not use any other result.

9	**Start BotFather** Tap START at the bottom of the screen. → **Tap START**

BotFather sends you a welcome message with a list of commands.

10	**Create a new bot** Tap the message input field at the bottom. Type the command exactly as shown. → **Type: /newbot → Tap Send**

BotFather replies: Alright, a new bot. How are we going to call it? Please choose a name for your bot.

11	**Choose a name for your bot** This is the display name people see when they find your bot. It can be anything — most people use something like their name plus CoS or Assistant. → **Type a name, e.g: VELA CoS → Tap Send**

BotFather replies: Good. Now let's choose a username for your bot. It must end in 'bot'. Like this, for example: TetrisBot or tetris_bot.

12	**Choose a username for your bot** The username must end in the word bot. It cannot have spaces. It must be unique across all of Telegram. → **Type a username, e.g: VELAcos_yourname_bot → Tap Send**

If BotFather says the username is already taken, try adding your last name or a number: VELAcos_smith_bot or VELAcos_1_bot. Keep trying until one works.

13	**Copy your bot token — this is the most important step** BotFather replies with a congratulations message. In the middle of that message is your bot token. It looks exactly like this:

Bot token:	`8459904439:AAE4r3u7lyyQ6E_DiataGN40Nzv_6svH0ug`

→ Press and hold on the token → Tap Copy

Paste it immediately into your password manager labeled: Telegram Bot Token. This token gives full control over your bot. Treat it like a password. If you lose it, you can get it again from BotFather using /mybots — but store it now.

14	**Enable inline mode on your bot** This allows Hannah to respond inline. Still in BotFather, type: → **Type: /setinline → Tap Send**

BotFather asks you to choose a bot. Tap your bot's username from the list. BotFather then asks for a placeholder — type anything short, like query, and send it. Inline mode is now on.

4 Create Your VELA Command Group

5 minutes

The group is where Hannah posts full work output — research briefs, financial models, contract reviews. You see a short summary in your DM with Hannah, and the full document posts to the group for reference. The group also lets you have separate topic threads for each specialist agent.

15 Create a new group

In Telegram, tap the pencil / compose icon in the top-right corner of the screen.

→ **Tap the pencil icon → Tap New Group**

16 Add your bot to the group

Telegram asks you to add members. Search for your bot's username.

→ **Search for your bot username, e.g. VELAcos_yourname_bot → Tap it to select → Tap Next**

17 Name the group

Telegram asks for a group name.

→ **Type: VELA Command → Tap Create**

Your group is created. You and your bot are both members.

18 Enable Topics in the group

Topics let Hannah post output to organized threads — one per agent. To enable them:

Tap the group name at the top of the screen to open the group info. Tap Edit (pencil icon in the top right). Scroll down until you see Topics. Tap the toggle to turn Topics ON.

→ **Tap Done to save**

19 Make your bot an Administrator

Hannah needs admin permissions to post to topics and manage threads. Tap the group name to open group info. Tap Administrators. Tap Add Administrator.

→ **Search for your bot username → Tap it**

A permissions screen appears. Leave all permissions as they are — the defaults are fine.

→ Tap Done

Your bot is now an admin of the group.

20	**Get your Group ID** You need the Group ID — a negative number that identifies your group. You get it the same way you got your User ID: by messaging @userinfobot, but this time from inside the group.

Go to your VELA Command group. Tap the message input field. Type @userinfobot and send it as a message in the group.
The bot replies inside the group with information including the Chat ID. It looks like this:

Chat ID:	-1003750313044

→ Copy the Chat ID — that is your Group ID

It is a negative number — it starts with a minus sign. This is correct and expected. Save it in your password manager labeled: Telegram Group ID

5 Create Agent Topics in Your Group

3 minutes

Hannah posts agent output to specific topic threads in your group — one for each specialist. Create these topics now so they are ready when Hannah starts posting.

21 Open your VELA Command group

Tap on the VELA Command group in your chat list.

22 Create the first topic

Tap the pencil/compose icon inside the group. Tap New Topic.

→ **Tap New Topic**

→ **Type: Analyst → Tap Create**

Repeat this for each of the following topics — create one at a time:

Topic Name	What Posts Here
Analyst	Financial models, projections, scenario analysis
Researcher	Research briefs, market intelligence, due diligence
Marketing	Copy drafts, positioning documents, campaign strategy
PM	Project status updates, action item tracking, milestone reports
Legal	Contract reviews, risk flags, compliance notes
System	Hannah's automated briefs, cost alerts, system notices

The topic names matter — create them exactly as listed above. Hannah uses these names to route output to the correct thread.

✓ You're Done — Final Checklist

Before your installation call, confirm you have all of these:

- ☐ Telegram installed on your iPhone and account created
- ☐ Notifications allowed for Telegram
- ☐ Your Telegram User ID saved (positive number from @userinfobot)
- ☐ Bot created via @BotFather — bot token saved in password manager

- ☐ Inline mode enabled on your bot (/setinline)
- ☐ VELA Command group created with Topics enabled
- ☐ Your bot is an Administrator of the group
- ☐ Group ID saved in password manager (negative number — starts with minus sign)
- ☐ All 6 topics created: Analyst, Researcher, Marketing, PM, Legal, System

Bring your Bot Token and Group ID to the installation call. Your installer handles everything else from there.

greg@gregshindler.com · 202-439-5834 · Telegram: @Vela_Greg

? Common Problems

If you see this...	Do this
BotFather says username is already taken	Add your last name or a number: VELAcos_smith_bot or VELAcos2_bot
You can't find the Topics option in group settings	Topics only appear in groups, not channels. Make sure you created a Group, not a Channel. Also confirm you are the group owner.
@userinfobot doesn't reply in the group	Make sure you sent it as a message in the group, not in a direct message. Type @userinfobot and hit send inside the VELA Command group.
The Group ID is a positive number, not negative	You messaged @userinfobot in a direct message, not in the group. Go into the VELA Command group and message it from there. Group IDs always start with a minus sign.
You lost your bot token	Open Telegram, search @BotFather, send /mybots, tap your bot name, tap API Token. It shows your token again.